

What I've done is curated a series of exercise habits that might not quite bring me joy, but suits my life experience, finances, environment and personality.

I want you to adopt a similar approach for your finances. It's acknowledging that, sure, just like my exercise regime, managing your finances may never bring you joy. But when you pick the right habits for your Financial Phenotype, dealing with money should eventually become easier.

Not straightaway, mind you. Even the most natural runner will suffer and find it difficult when they first start training for a marathon. The difference between that natural marathon runner and someone like me is that personally, long-distance running feels perpetually wrong and compoundingly difficult. Contrast that to playing netball in my younger days, which utilised my natural ability to sprint. This meant I was good at it and therefore enjoyed it more. Even though developing my netball skills was still challenging, I would happily spend time practising, so it became easier and enjoyable. When you compare this to the exercise habits in my adult life, you'll understand that sometimes you might not always be able to do what brings you joy, but you can still find a system that works for you. In other words, I've learned to apply self-control so that I exercise regularly through finding a set of exercise habits that works for me.

What we're wanting to do here, no matter your Money Type, is to curate a series of habits that will lead to all-important overarching qualities: financial self-control and willpower. These habits give you the ability to enjoy today and to look after your future self.

The best way to strengthen willpower and to increase your self-control is to turn them into habits. Remember the marshmallow experiment on self-control in [Chapter 2](#)? Years later the researchers tracked down the children from the study. They observed that the children in the study who were able to delay gratification with their marshmallow the longest performed better academically than the children who gave in to their impulses. They had the best grades and had Scholastic Aptitude Test scores 210 points higher than the average. These kids weren't the smartest; they were just able to use techniques to strengthen their self-control.

Here, it's about creating routines, patterns and systems that are right for you. We're creating habits for your finances that will help you exercise